

Understanding Cold Symptoms & Recovery

Symptoms of a common cold usually peak within 2 to 3 days and include sore throat, runny nose, coughing, sneezing, headaches, and body aches.

Self-Care Recovery Steps: - Rest: Get plenty of rest to help your body fight off the virus. - Fluids: Drink fluids like water, clear broths, or warm lemon water to prevent dehydration. - Humidity: Use a clean cool-mist humidifier or steam from a warm shower to relieve congestion.

Antibiotic Awareness: Antibiotics do NOT treat viral colds. Taking antibiotics when not needed increases antibiotic resistance risks.

Symptom Timeline and Clinical Evaluation

Cold symptoms typically improve within 7 to 10 days. When to Call a Doctor: - Symptoms that worsen or fail to improve after 10 days. - Severe or unusual symptoms, such as sudden high fever or severe chest pain. - Symptoms in individuals at high risk for flu complications.

Nasal Congestion & Sinus Pressure Relief

Non-pharmacological measures for nasal discomfort: - Saline Spray: Use sterile saline nasal sprays to keep nasal passages moist. - Warm Compress: Apply a warm washcloth over your nose and forehead to ease sinus pressure.

Preventing Viral Spread at Home

Simple daily steps to keep cold viruses from spreading: - Disinfect frequently touched surfaces like doorknobs and light switches. - Stay home from work or public places when actively coughing or sneezing.